Owen Hejna

Ecologist and Educator
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Website · LinkedIn · GitHub

Education

B.S., *Ecology* Graduated *cum laude*, May 2024
Loyola University Chicago
University Research: Laboratory of Bioinformatics, Laboratory of Aquatic Ecology, Urban Agriculture Program

Experience

Volunteer Engagement Coordinator Since August 2026
Indiana Audubon Society, Independent Contractor Role

Secretive Marshbird Coordinator Since February 2026
Indiana Audubon Society, Independent Contractor Role

Program Instructor II Since February 2026
Evanston Ecology Center, Evanston, IL

Community Science Coordinator April – December 2025
Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL

Summer Research Intern June – September 2024
Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL

DNA Barcoding of Neotropical Fishes Intern June – August 2023
The Field Museum, Chicago, IL

Shoreline Maintenance Technician June – August 2022
Chicago Botanic Garden, Glencoe, IL

Certifications

Bird Guide Ambassador Issued Aug 2026
Indiana Audubon

Adult First Aid CPR/AED All Ages Issued Jun 2026
Health and Safety Institute

Acoustic Bat Call Identification Issued May 2025
Vesper Bat Detection Services

Mandated Reporter Issued May 2025
Illinois Department of Children and Family Services

Organization Affiliations

Midwest Society for Acoustic Ecology Since May 2026
Member

Illinois Bat Working Group Since March 2026
Member

Urban Wildlife Institute Since January 2026
GIS Analyst, Acoustic Analyst

Chicago Ornithological Society (COS) Since November 2025
Calumet Conservation Committee, MAPS Bird Bander (2026)

Urban Rivers Since June 2025
Educator

National Society of Collegiate Scholars 2020 – 2024
Member

Scientific Articles

Planet Forward Published October 2025
Chicago's people-powered Bat Tracker: Citizen scientists seek a different bat signal

Selected Presentations

Marshbird Monitoring in the Calumet Presented September 2026
Urban Birding Festival

Attended Events

Urban Birding Festival September 2026
Presenter, Trip Guide

Indiana Dunes Birding Festival May 2026
Trip Guide

Midwest Bat Working Group Annual Meeting April 2026

Urban Wildlife Information Network Summit September 2025

Midwest Beaver Summit August 2024